



ModForge

AI Mod & Asset Toolkit

The Complete Beginner's Guide

Version 0.9.0 · Windows

No experience needed. If you can open a folder and click a button, you can use this guide.

1. What is ModForge?

ModForge is a free program for your Windows PC that helps you look at and change the settings and save files that games (and other apps) use — safely, without needing to be a programmer. Games store settings and progress in files; normally you'd have to hand-edit confusing text or raw binary. ModForge opens them as a neat list you can change like filling in a form, and it **always makes a backup first** so you can't break anything permanently.

It's really a whole toolbox in one window, with tabs across the top — like a Swiss Army knife where each fold-out tool does one job. Newer versions can even **read binary saves** from Unity / C# mobile games, **pull saves off an Android phone over USB**, and let an **AI turn a plain-English goal** ("max all resources") into concrete edits you approve.

TIP — You do NOT need to know what "JSON" or "binary" means to use ModForge. There's a plain-English glossary at the end of this guide (Section 13) if you ever see a word you don't recognize.

2. The nine tools (tabs)

Across the top of ModForge are the tabs. Here's what each one is for, in plain terms:

Tab	What it's for
Editor	Open a text settings/save file and change values as simple fields. Backup every save.
Trainer	Auto-find money / health / resources in a JSON, XML, INI or SQLite save and edit or Max them.
AI Agent	Opens binary saves (.NET BinaryFormatter, used by many mobile games). Describe a goal in plain English; an AI proposes exact edits you approve.
Device	Connect an Android phone over USB, find the running game, pull its save, edit it, push it back.
Database	Browse and edit a SQLite save table-by-table, cell-by-cell.
Converter	Turn one settings format into another (JSON, YAML, TOML, INI, XML, CSV).
Log Explainer	Paste a scary crash message; get a plain-English cause, fix, and why.
Planner	Plan a build/loadout with costs and values against a budget; get an AI review.
Tracker	Log anything (runs, playtime) and see totals, your best, and a daily streak.

NOTE — Most tools work fully offline. Only the AI features (buttons like "Explain", "Plan edits", "AI review") need the internet and an optional key — see Section 5. The Device tab needs Android platform-tools ("adb") — see Section 8.

3. Installing ModForge

Installing is just running one file. Here's exactly what to do:

- 1 Download **ModForge_0.9.0_x64-setup.exe** from the Releases page.
- 2 Double-click that file. A small installer window opens.
- 3 Click through it (Next / Install). It installs just for you — **no administrator password needed**.
- 4 When it finishes, ModForge is in your Start Menu. Click it to open.

HEADS UP — Windows may show a blue box that says **"Windows protected your PC."** This is NOT a virus warning — it appears for every new app that hasn't paid for a "signing certificate" yet. To continue: click **"More info"**, then the **"Run anyway"** button that appears.

Don't want to install anything? There's also a portable **ModForge.exe** you can just double-click to run from any folder — no installation.

4. A quick look at the window

When ModForge opens you'll see three parts:

- **The top bar** — the ModForge logo on the left, and the tabs (Editor, Trainer, AI Agent, Converter, Log Explainer, Planner, Tracker, Database, Device). Click a tab to switch tools.
- **The middle** — the tool you're currently using.
- **The bottom strip** — a status line that tells you what just happened ("Wrote 3 edits · backup made", "Pulled save → opening in Agent", etc.).

TIP — Whenever you're unsure whether something worked, glance at that bottom status strip — it confirms every action.

5. Turning on the AI helper (optional)

Some buttons in ModForge use AI to explain files, review builds, decode crash logs, or plan save edits. These are optional. To use them you provide your own API key. Here's how:

- 1 In a web browser, go to **console.anthropic.com** and sign up / log in.
- 2 Find **Settings > API Keys** and create a new key. It's a long code starting with "sk-ant-". Copy it.
- 3 In ModForge, go to the **Editor** tab. On the right is the **AI assistant** panel — click **settings**.
- 4 Paste your key, choose a model, and click **Save settings**.

NOTE — Your key is stored only on your PC. Using the AI may cost a small amount on your Anthropic account (usually a fraction of a cent per question). If you never add a key, everything except the AI buttons still works.

Which model? "Balanced" is a good default. "Fastest" is cheapest. "Most capable" is the most thorough. You can switch anytime.

6. The Editor

The Editor changes a game's **text** settings safely (JSON, INI, TOML, YAML, XML, CSV).

- 1 Click **Open file...** and pick a settings or save file (for example a *.json*, *.ini*, or *.cfg*).
 - 2 ModForge shows every setting as a row: the name on the left, its value in the middle.
 - 3 Find the value you want and type a new one. (On/off settings show a checkbox.)
 - 4 Click **Save**. A backup is made first; the game uses your new value next time it loads.
- **Filter fields** — search box to jump to a setting by name.
 - **Undo / Redo** — step backward or forward through changes. Experiment freely.
 - **Duplicate / Delete** — copy a repeating item, or remove one.
 - **Backup on save** — a checkbox (on by default). Leave it on!

7. Editing game saves — the Trainer & the AI Agent

These two tools find the "good stuff" (money, health, resources, levels) in a save automatically, so you don't have to hunt for it.

The Trainer — for readable saves (JSON, XML, INI, and SQLite databases).

- 1 Open the **Trainer** tab and click **Open game save...** (or it opens automatically after a device pull).
- 2 It scans the file and groups every editable number: Money, Health, Resources, Level, etc.
- 3 Type a new value for anything, or hit **Max**. Every change is backed up first.
- 4 Tip: type a number you can see in-game (like 500) in the filter box to jump straight to it.

The AI Agent — for binary saves the Trainer can't read.

Many Unity / C# mobile games store saves in a packed binary format called **.NET BinaryFormatter (NRBF)** — it looks like gibberish in a text editor. The AI Agent understands it: it reads the save's internal structure and labels every number and on/off flag by name.

- 1 Open the **AI Agent** tab and click **Open save...** (or it opens automatically after a device pull).
- 2 It lists every editable field, grouped by category, and recovers resource tables even in deeply-nested saves.
- 3 In the goal box, type what you want in plain English — e.g. *"set gems to 10000"*, *"max all resources"*, *"unlock the gun"* — and click **Plan edits**.
- 4 The AI proposes specific changes, each with a reason. **Review them** (tick/untick, tweak values).
- 5 Click **Apply & save**. A timestamped backup is written first.

NOTE — You can also edit any field by hand in the list, or use the **10k** button next to a number. The AI is optional — the field browser works without a key. The Agent also reads **Protocol Buffers** saves (another common binary format), and the format it detected is shown next to the file name.

TIP — Made a change you regret? Click **Restore backup** in the Agent's toolbar and pick any earlier version from the list — no file renaming. The current file is itself backed up first, so even a restore is undoable.

TIP — The Agent is built to edit **gameplay values** (currency, resources, levels, unlock flags). It deliberately avoids fabricating purchase / in-app-purchase records.

8. Editing Android game saves over USB (Device tab)

The Device tab pulls a save straight off an Android phone or tablet, opens it for editing, and pushes it back — no rooting needed for the common case.

One-time phone setup

- 1 On the phone: **Settings > About > tap "Build number" 7 times** to unlock Developer options.
- 2 **Settings > Developer options > turn on "USB debugging"** (and "Stay awake").
- 3 Plug the phone into your PC. Set the USB mode to **File Transfer / MTP**.
- 4 Tap **Allow** on the "Allow USB debugging?" popup, and tick "Always allow from this computer".

Install adb — the Device tab uses Google's **adb** tool. Download "Android platform-tools" from developer.android.com, and add it to your PATH (or put adb.exe where ModForge can find it). Verify by running *adb devices*: your phone should appear as "device".

Grab, edit, push

- 1 Open your game **on the phone** so it's the app in front.
- 2 In ModForge's **Device** tab, click **Grab current game**. It finds the game, stops it, and lists its saves.
- 3 Click a save file — it's pulled to your PC and **opens in the AI Agent** automatically.
- 4 Edit the values you want (Section 7), then come back to Device and click **Push edited save back**.
- 5 Reopen the game to see your changes.

HEADS UP — Fully close the game (swipe it away) before reopening after a push — otherwise it may reload the old values from memory and overwrite your edit. Saves in protected */data/data/* storage need a rooted phone; most casual games keep their save in */sdcard/Android/data/*, which needs no root.

9. The Converter

Sometimes a mod guide gives you settings in one format but your game wants another. The Converter translates between them.

- 1 Open the **Converter** tab.
- 2 Paste your text on the left (or click **Load file...**). ModForge auto-detects the format.
- 3 On the right, pick the format you want to convert *to*.
- 4 Click **Convert**. Then **Copy** the result or **Save as...** a file.

NOTE — Supported: JSON, YAML, TOML, INI, XML, and CSV. If it can't understand your input, it tells you what's wrong.

10. The Log Explainer

When a game or mod crashes, it usually spits out a wall of confusing text. This tool turns that into a clear answer.

- 1 Open the **Log Explainer** tab. Paste the crash text (or **Load log file...**).
- 2 Click **Explain error**.
- 3 Read the answer: **Cause** (what went wrong), **Fix** (what to do), and **Why**.

NOTE — This uses the AI helper, so you'll need a key set up (Section 5). Long logs are trimmed to the important part.

11. The Planner & Tracker

The Planner — plan a build/loadout that fits a budget.

- 1 Open the **Planner** tab. Name your build and set a **Budget**.
- 2 Click **+ Add part**; give each a name, **Cost**, and **Value** (how good it is, any scale).
- 3 The totals bar adds cost vs budget (red if over) and shows efficiency. Click **AI review build** for tips.

The Tracker — log anything and watch your progress and streaks.

- 1 Open the **Tracker** tab. Enter a **category** ("Runs"), a **value**, an optional **note**; click **Log**.
- 2 Cards up top show your total, best, count, and **day streak**. Use **AI analyze** for a trend summary.

NOTE — Builds and logs are saved on your PC automatically. Nothing is uploaded unless you press an AI button.

12. Staying safe & fixing problems

Backups — your safety net

Every time ModForge writes a file it first copies the original next to itself with a name ending in **.modforge-bak-** and a number. To restore one:

- 1 Close the game (and, for a phone, don't let it re-save).
- 2 Find the newest file ending in *.modforge-bak-...* next to your file.
- 3 Delete your changed file, then rename the backup back to the original name (remove the ".modforge-bak-..." part).
- 4 Start the game — you're back to how it was. (For a phone save, push the restored file back with the Device tab.)

Common questions

- **"Windows protected your PC" on install** — normal for unsigned apps. Click More info > Run anyway.
- **An AI button says "no key"** — add your Anthropic key in the Editor's AI settings (Section 5).
- **The Device tab says "adb error"** — install Android platform-tools and check *adb devices* lists your phone (Section 8).
- **Phone not detected** — confirm USB debugging is ON and you tapped "Allow" on the phone; set USB mode to File Transfer.
- **Edit didn't show in the game** — the game was still running and reloaded old data; fully close it, push again, reopen.
- **A save opens with few/no fields** — it may use a format ModForge doesn't parse yet (encrypted, protobuf).

HEADS UP — Golden rules: **always close the game before editing its save**, keep backups on, and only edit **offline, single-player** games you own. Do that and you can experiment without fear.

13. Plain-English glossary

Config file	A file that stores a program's settings (graphics, controls, gameplay values).
Save file	A file where a game stores your progress and character/inventory data.
JSON / INI / TOML / YAML / XML / CSV	Common text formats for settings files. ModForge handles all of them.
SQLite	A small database file some games use as their save. The Trainer and Database tabs read it.
.NET BinaryFormatter / NRBF	A packed binary save format used by many Unity / C# games. The AI Agent reads it.
Field	One setting and its value — like one line in a form.
Backup	A safety copy of a file made before you change it, so you can undo.
adb	"Android Debug Bridge" — Google's tool that lets your PC talk to an Android phone over USB.
USB debugging	A phone setting (in Developer options) that lets a PC read/write app files over USB.
API key	A private code that lets ModForge use the AI service on your behalf. You create your own.
Crash log	The text a program prints when it crashes, describing what went wrong.

That's everything you need to get started. Open a save, describe what you want, watch the backup appear — and enjoy modding your own offline games without the fear of breaking things.

ModForge is free and open source (MIT license).